Criteria for Recognition

The Election Commission of India has some criteria for the recognition of political parties in India.

National Parties	Regional / State Parties	Independent candidate
Parties that secure atleast 6% of the valid votes in Lok sabha election or assembly elections in four states.	Parties that secures atleast 6% of the valid votes in the state legislative assembly election.	A candidate who wishes to contest in either of the Parliamentary, State Assembly but does not have an affliation with the other parties, may contest the election as an Independent candidate.
They must win 4 seats in Lok sabha from any State/States.	They must win one Lok Sabha seat for every 25 seats or atleast 2 seats in Legislative assembly.	
They have to win 2% of seats in Lok sabha from atleast 3 different states in the latest general election.	They need to win a minimum of 3% of the total number of seats in Legislative Assembly.	

Recognized parties

Parties that fulfill these criteria are called recognized parties. They are given a unique symbol by the Election Commission.

A registered but unrecognized political party cannot contest election on its own symbol. This party has to choose one symbol from free symbol 'poll panel' announced by the Election Commission.

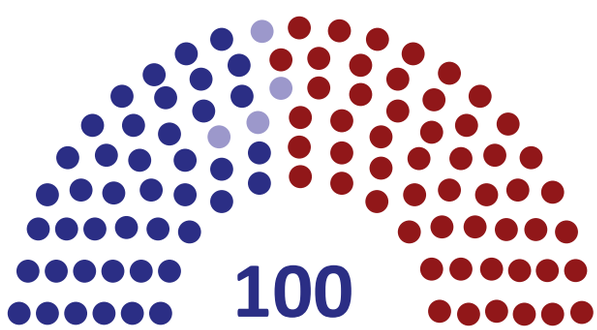
Free symbols 'Poll panel'

As per the Election Symbols order 1968, symbols are either reserved or free.

- A reserved symbol is meant for a recognized political party.
- A free symbol is reserved for unrecognized party.

Majority Party

The Political party whose number of candidates elected is more than that of the others parties is called the majority party. The Majority Party forms and runs the government. They select and appoint their ministers to run the government. They play a decisive role in making laws for the country.



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